

CASE ID: 202410710713

EPISODE NAME: China Sanctions Taiwan businessman Robert Tsao

2024/10/14 - Ongoing

Sender: China (710)

Target: Taiwan (713)

Issue: Contain Military Behavior (2)

Final Outcome: Stalemate after Sanctions Imposition (9)

Summary:

On 2024/10/14, China sanctioned two Taiwanese individuals: businessman Robert Tsao and lawmaker Puma Shen. They are involved in civilian defense programs intended to protect Taiwanese citizens against a Chinese invasion. Tsao and Shen are now prevented from entering or conducting business in China.

Narrative:

On 2024/10/14, China imposed sanctions on Taiwan to contain its military actions.¹ The sanctions specifically target two Taiwanese individuals: businessman Robert Tsao and lawmaker Puma Shen.² Robert Tsao has provided hundreds of millions in USD to programs which train Taiwanese civilians in “survival skills, military training, and courses on counter-surveillance”.³ Shen has helped run one of these programs: “Black Bear Academy”.⁴

The initial onset of the episode began when Chen Binhua, a spokesman of China’s Taiwan Affairs Office (TAO), said: “Shen and Tsao’s stubborn ‘Taiwan independence’ ideology, their brazen ‘independence’ statements, their malicious actions aiming for ‘independence’, and their reckless reliance on foreign powers to oppose China are blatant acts of splitting the country and inciting division.”⁵ The bureaucratic sanctions on Tsao and Shen were imposed by Beijing’s Taiwan

¹ Promfret, James, and Ben Blanchard. “China Sanctions Taiwan Businessman Robert Tsao and Lawmaker for ‘separatist’ Acts.” *Reuters*, 14 Oct. 2024, www.reuters.com/world/asia-pacific/china-sanctions-taiwan-businessman-robert-tsao-lawmaker-separatist-acts-2024-10-14/.

² Ibid.

³ Liang, Xinlu. “Beijing Sanctions Taiwan Tech Billionaire Robert Tsao and DPP Lawmaker Puma Shen.” *South China Morning Post*, 14 Oct. 2024, www.scmp.com/news/china/politics/article/3282330/beijing-sanctions-taiwan-tech-billionaire-robert-tsao-and-dpp-lawmaker-puma-shen.

⁴ Promfret, James, and Ben Blanchard. “China Sanctions Taiwan Businessman Robert Tsao and Lawmaker for ‘separatist’ Acts.” *Reuters*, 14 Oct. 2024, www.reuters.com/world/asia-pacific/china-sanctions-taiwan-businessman-robert-tsao-lawmaker-separatist-acts-2024-10-14/.

⁵ Liang, Xinlu. “Beijing Sanctions Taiwan Tech Billionaire Robert Tsao and DPP Lawmaker Puma Shen.” *South China Morning Post*, 14 Oct. 2024,

Affairs Office (TAO), and consisted of a travel ban, preventing them from entering China, and an import and export restriction, preventing businesses associated with them from selling or buying products in China.⁶

This episode is ongoing as of 2025/08/03.

www.scmp.com/news/china/politics/article/3282330/beijing-sanctions-taiwan-tech-billionaire-robert-tsao-and-dpp-lawmaker-puma-shen.

⁶ Ibid.